

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 8, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 13:8-13

8 Love never fails. But whether there are prophecies, they will fail; whether there are tongues, they will cease; whether there is knowledge, it will vanish away.

9 For we know in part and we prophesy in part.

10 But when that which is perfect has come, then that which is in part will be done away.

11 When I was a child, I spoke as a child, I understood as a child, I thought as a child; but when I became a man, I put away childish things.

12 For now we see in a mirror, dimly, but then face to face. Now I know in part, but then I shall know just as I also am known.

13 And now abide faith, hope, love, these three; but the greatest of these is love.

II. Key Summary

- Paul states that prophecies, tongues, and knowledge will all eventually end, while love alone never fails.
 - Paul uses the image of a child growing up and setting aside childish things to show that spiritual gifts belong to this current age and will pass when "that which is perfect" comes.
 - Paul places faith, hope, and love together as three things that remain, identifying love as the greatest of the three.
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III. Passage Analysis

Love Is the Only Thing That Lasts

Love "always holds its place" and remains steadfast — unlike prophecies, tongues,

and knowledge, which are all destined to cease. [1]

Paul isn't saying the gifts are bad. He's saying they have an expiration date — like notes you take before an exam, they serve their purpose and then they're done. Love is the only thing that never runs out. It's the only thing that carries into eternity.

Seeing Dimly Now — And That's Okay

"The city of Corinth was famous for producing some of the best bronze mirrors in antiquity, but at their best, they couldn't give a really clear vision. We see Jesus now only in a dim, unclear way, but one day we will see Him with perfect clarity." [2]

Paul says "now I know in part" — and that's not a faith problem, it's just the reality of where we are right now. A lot of things don't make complete sense yet, and our understanding of God feels incomplete at times. But here's the other side of it: God already knows us completely, even while we're still figuring things out.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever worked really hard at something — a grade, a sport, a skill — something that made you feel like you had your footing at school, and then it stopped working? When that moment came, what or who was still around?

Paul says love is the only thing that doesn't end. If that's true, are the things you're currently counting on to hold you up actually built to last?

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Multiple Commentators,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/13-8.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-13/>